

Chapter 63-3

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The wind was strong at night, and Xu Qingzhu could hear it clearly from the second floor.

It was probably also related to her slight insomnia.

She first lay in bed looking at those comments, as if she were playing with Weibo¹ for the first time. After looking at her own Weibo, she went to look at entries related to Chen Liuying and Bai Weiwei. Everyone was cursing in various creative ways, sarcastically making veiled criticisms.

The more she looked, the more excited she became, not feeling tired at all.

Then she went to look at Liang Shi's Weibo.

Her main account name was simply Liang Shi, with the bio stating: An actor who is working hard to improve.

This day happened to coincide with the promotional campaign for "Afterglow," but the trending topics the production team had paid for were all suppressed by Bai Weiwei and the others.

The director must be regretting this to death.

The money spent on trending topics had all gone to waste.

Xu Qingzhu nestled under the covers looking at the "Afterglow" promotional photos.

She had read a bit of the script before Liang Shi's audition, so she had some understanding of this character—a white-turning-black² antagonist. The promotional photos that were released had a great atmospheric quality.

Liang Shi's camera presence was excellent. In this series of officially released posters, only hers and Zhao Ying's posters had that blockbuster quality.

The others, whether due to their appearance or editing issues, were slightly inferior.

Xu Qingzhu directly followed Liang Shi's Weibo with her main account, as well as Zhao Ying, Yang Shuyan, Sally, and Cherry.

Zhou Yi'an hadn't previously reported her Weibo to the company.

She did search online but couldn't find Zhou Yi'an.

However, she did find the Weibo account of RT's Annual Emerging Designer, which had an English name: Leona.

Liang Shi's English name was Leo.

This probably wasn't a coincidence that was actually a coincidence?

But Xu Qingzhu didn't know what Zhou Yi'an was thinking.

Nevertheless, she still followed Zhou Yi'an.

And sent her a private message to thank her.

This person was probably addicted to staying up late, and also liked surfing the internet while staying up late. She replied almost instantly with: ?

But immediately deleted it.

Then said nothing more.

But she followed back.

Xu Qingzhu looked through her following list and found it pitifully small—just two internationally renowned designers, Liang Shi, and herself.

A few seconds later, Sally and Lin Luoxi were added.

After doing all this, Xu Qingzhu planned to sleep, but when she closed her eyes, her mind was full of Liang Shi.

She had methodically arranged for everyone to handle those crises, thoughtfully helped everyone order dinner, and sent everyone off after everything was finished.

Just like their department gathering last time.

Liang Shi did everything perfectly, and could even perceive why she was sensitive and vulnerable during those sensitive and vulnerable moments.

She was such a gentle person.

But so gentle she forgot about herself.

As Xu Qingzhu thought about this, she started thinking about her series of crisis management operations during the day.

Since she couldn't sleep anyway, she got up and made a spreadsheet, listing out Liang Shi's entire process from today.

She had thought of everything.

Even implicating Dongheng's rival Changli.

She had cast an enormous net.

Although she didn't know what Liang Shi had called Zhou Yi'an to discuss, she must have obtained some even more significant evidence.

Xu Qingzhu guessed it was related to the previous Huayue International incident.

But the fact that Liang Shi held onto that information also showed she held onto her moral boundaries.

There was no need to use such dirty personal matters to attack people.

Liang Shi had arranged everything with great discretion.

At this moment, Xu Qingzhu didn't even think about who she really was, but kept thinking: could such a perfect person exist in this world?

Didn't she have any weaknesses?

Was she this good to everyone? This considerate?

Or was it only toward her?

Xu Qingzhu couldn't even tell if she was curious or... if she liked her.

It seemed like she did, a little.

Such a person—it seemed no one wouldn't like them.

Just like Zhao Xuning, who used to really dislike her, didn't she also find the current Liang Shi very charismatic?

This kind of personal charm made her entire being shine.

So in the quiet late hours, Xu Qingzhu opened her tablet's drawing software and drew Liang Shi.

By the time she realized it, Liang Shi's image was already vivid on the paper.

Afterward, she dispersed those romantic thoughts and forced herself to sleep.

When she found herself unable to think about Liang Shi rationally, she went to another extreme—if something is too perfect, it must be a disguise.

Time passed as she overthought things.

Around the time when dawn was breaking, she finally fell asleep.

When the alarm went off, it startled her awake.

But she still had to force herself to get up for work.

She couldn't slack off today either.

And on her bedside tablet, when opened, there was the portrait she had drawn last night.

She sat on the edge of the bed and drank some water before finally calming her emotions.

Being curious about and appreciating someone didn't mean anything.

She comforted herself this way.

Then went to wash up, discovering in the mirror that she had two big dark circles. She used a lot of concealer before barely managing to cover them.

As a result, when she came downstairs and saw Liang Shi, Liang Shi's first words were: "Teacher Xu, your all-nighter skills are really improving!"

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

She sat at the dining table, looking at the bread on her plate without much energy, "Is it that obvious?"

Liang Shi nodded, placing milk in front of Xu Qingzhu while she had soy milk in front of herself, "You followed my Weibo at 3:30 AM last night."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

She coughed to cover her embarrassment, "Accident."

Liang Shi just smiled helplessly, "Go to bed earlier from now on."

Xu Qingzhu mumbled a response, then left.

Footnotes:

¹ Weibo: China's equivalent of Twitter, a popular social media platform for microblogging.

² White-turning-black: A Chinese term (白切黑) referring to a character who appears innocent and pure on the surface but is actually manipulative or villainous underneath; can also refer to a character who transforms from good to evil.